

A LIFE IN COLOUR

Picking a printer for home no longer means making a choice between great colour prints and low maintenance costs. Let us take a look at a few printers that manage to do both

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► **Printing has** come a long way since Johannes Gutenberg developed the first movable type printer in the 15th century. For a home printer, there are, broadly, two choices: inkjet and laser. While inkjet printers are known for vibrant colour prints, laser printers are generally used for black-and-white ones. Inkjet printers have lower

upfront costs, but are expensive to run, with the cost of ink cartridges adding up to be higher than the printer itself. Laser printers are cheaper to run, but are more expensive upfront. What, then, does one do if one wants a printer that is easy to maintain and prints in colour? Meet ink-tank printers, which have gained traction among home users in recent years.

Compact in size, ink-tank printers have individual colour tanks—for black, magenta, cyan and yellow inks. And you just need to refill each tank—an easy process using spill-free bottles—as the ink runs out. Ink-tank printers output vibrant colours like inkjet printers, but at a much lesser cost per page. They are inexpensive to maintain, though the upfront costs are higher than inkjets. Easy to set up, these printers are the perfect companion for your home desk. Here are our top picks.

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AT YOUR FINGERTIPS

This all-in-one printer, which offers great colour prints, supports dual-band Wi-Fi along with Bluetooth LE for faster and more reliable connections. It can print 11 black pages a minute or five colour ones. The transparent tanks make it convenient to monitor ink levels. And it lets you do everything—print, scan and even order supplies—on the nifty HP Smart mobile app, with a few taps. Ideal for low-cost, high-volume printing, the ink that comes with the printer is good for up to 8,000 colour pages or 6,000 black-and-white pages, HP claims. Original ink refill bottles are inexpensive too—the 135-ml black one is priced at ₹596, while the 70-ml bottles of cyan, magenta and yellow cost ₹524 each.

Available on: hp.com/in

